RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

17 OCTOBER 2026

# Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 6:17 AM, Saturday 17 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 18 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Halted** · 21 cancelled

Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday, 7,710 minutes at 6:00 AM; Dammam halted since 5:27 AM (50 minutes at 6:17 AM), no takeoff since 1:50 AM

**1**

INCIDENT SUMMARY

## What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 7,710 minutes at 6:00 AM; NOTAM keeps it closed until 12:00 AM Sunday 18 Oct, and GACA has not announced a reopening**.
- No Riyadh takeoff or landing in the last hour; 18 flights cancelled so far for Saturday (14% of scheduled).
- No new Civil Defense alert or intercept since the 5:00 AM edition; Al Ekhbariya reports Yemen condemning the Houthis' second strike on Aden airport.
- Dammam halted since 5:27 AM, 50 minutes at 6:17 AM: last landing flynas XY884 from Lahore at 5:27 AM, and no takeoff since Saudia SV1131 to Jeddah at 1:50 AM.
- EU-GCC summit in Riyadh reported postponed and UK reported to advise against all but essential travel to Saudi Arabia (media reports, unverified).

**RIYADH AIRPORT** RUH

HALTED

No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (7728 min).

| CANCELLED TODAY | TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H | DIVERTED |
|---|---|---|
| 18 | 0/0 | 0 |

**DAMMAM AIRPORT** DMM

HALTED

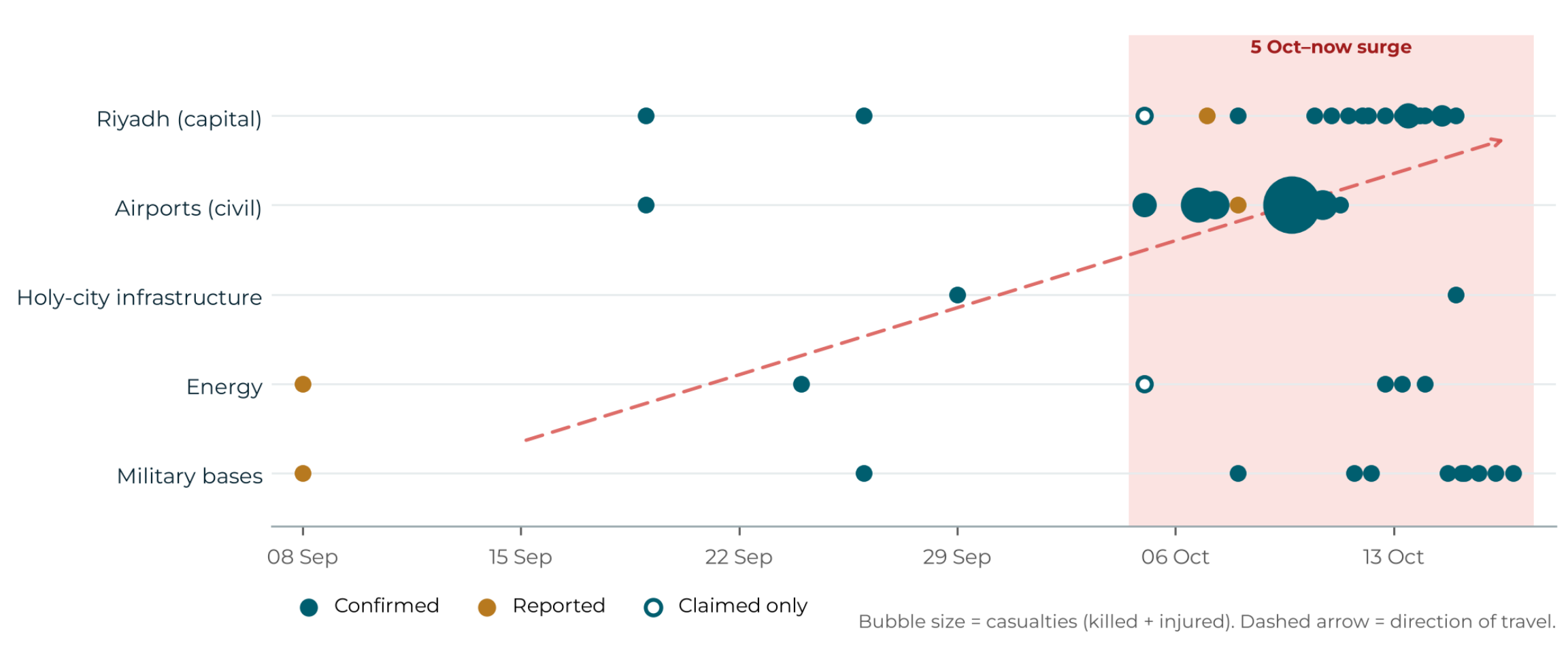
No takeoff or landing since 5:27 AM (50 min).

| CANCELLED TODAY | TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H | DIVERTED |
|---|---|---|
| 21 | 0/1 | 0 |

### WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday (7,710 min at 6:00 AM)
- Dammam halted again since 5:27 AM after one landing (XY884 from Lahore); no takeoff since 1:50 AM
- No new Civil Defense alert or intercept statement since 5:00 AM

### ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 17 OCT



Bubble size = casualties (killed + injured). Dashed arrow = direction of travel.

*45 sourced events since 8 September (39 confirmed). Latest: Coalition: three UAVs intercepted and destroyed in the southern and Riyadh regions (16 Oct, Coalition spokesman / SPA; none reported (intercept)). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.*

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet's Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam's King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

**2**

ATTACKS, INTERCEPTIONS & ALERTS (KSA-WIDE)

## Every attack, interception, Civil Defense alert and all-clear, debris fall and casualty report since 5:00 AM.

Sources: Coalition spokesman, SPA, Civil Defense, Interior and Energy ministries, Al Ekhbariya, Reuters/AP. Riyadh time.

**No new attacks, interceptions or alerts since 5:00 AM AST.**

**Last 24 hours: Attacks 1, interceptions 3, alerts 3, all-clears 3.**

**3**

NEWS AND STATEMENTS

## Riyadh still halted 18 hours before the NOTAM's planned reopening; Dammam halted again since 5:27 AM

Checked at 6:20 AM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya: Yemen's Transport Ministry condemns the Houthi militia's second attack on Aden International Airport**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **5:50 AM** · published 5:50 AM AST Sat 17 Oct (official Saudi channel, Arabic, translated); checked 6:20 AM

Saudi state channel Al Ekhbariya reported that Yemen's Ministry of Transport condemned the Houthi militia for targeting Aden International Airport for the second time.

UNVERIFIED **EU-GCC summit planned in Riyadh reported postponed amid Houthi strikes**

5W1H Brief (@5w1hbrief) · **6:16 AM** · posted 6:16 AM AST Sat 17 Oct, citing unnamed reports; no official GCC or EU statement checked; checked 6:20 AM

A news-summary account reported that the EU-Gulf Cooperation Council summit planned in Riyadh has been postponed, with a new date to be announced later. No official GCC or European Council statement has been seen yet.

UNVERIFIED **UK reported to advise against all but essential travel to Saudi Arabia**

X (@celticarab) · **5:40 AM** · posted 5:40 AM AST Sat 17 Oct; UK Foreign Office advisory not checked directly; checked 6:20 AM

A social post linked a report that the UK now advises against all but essential travel to Saudi Arabia because of the Houthi attacks. The Foreign Office page itself has not been checked.

CLAIM **Saudi military said to have destroyed two Houthi ballistic missile launchers in Yemen**

X (@TheWorldEye_) · **5:53 AM** · posted 5:53 AM AST Sat 17 Oct; no Coalition or Saudi defense ministry statement found in the official-account check; checked 6:20 AM

A single social account claimed the Saudi military neutralized two Houthi ballistic missile launchers in Yemen. The official Saudi accounts checked this hour carry no such statement.

UNVERIFIED **Trump says Saudi Arabia should accept Israel's offer of help against the Houthis**

Nepal News (X) · **4:47 AM** · Also relayed by Middle East Forum at 4:30 AM; checked 4:55 AM

Social and news accounts relay remarks by US President Donald Trump that Israel has been 'very helpful' to Saudi Arabia and that the Kingdom should accept its help against the Houthis. No Saudi official response has been published.

UNVERIFIED **Iran denies any role in the Houthi attacks on Saudi Arabia; Riyadh says Tehran encouraged them**

X (@HormuzWatch) · **4:38 AM** · Middle East Eye report relayed on X at 4:38 AM; first seen 3:38 AM; checked 4:55 AM

Middle East Eye, relayed by several accounts, reports Iran denies involvement and says the Houthis act on their own interests, while Saudi Arabia says Tehran encouraged the attacks. No Saudi official statement on this was found in the official-channel check.

UNVERIFIED **Brent reaches about $110 as Hormuz ship attacks and Houthi strikes on Saudi Arabia drive an oil rally**

Business Today (X) · **4:32 AM** · Checked 4:55 AM

Business Today reports Brent crude hit $110 a barrel on attacks on ships near Hormuz and Houthi strikes on the Kingdom. The report's own Brent quote is shown in the Economy section.

CONFIRMED **King Khalid airport again tells travelers to follow official authorities and their airline for airspace updates**

King Khalid Intl Airport (@KKIASA) · **3:40 AM** · published 3:40 AM AST Sat 17 Oct (reply on official account, translated from Arabic); checked 3:55 AM

Replying to a traveler, King Khalid International Airport said that for the latest airspace updates people should follow the competent official authorities or their airline. It gave no reopening time.

UNVERIFIED **Social accounts say Saudi Arabia reported six soldiers and officers killed in Thursday's Houthi missile attack on the Maashiq palace in Aden**

X (@WarTrackerX, @Pak_Osint, @WarUpdates) · **2:59 AM** · posted 2:58-2:59 AM AST Sat 17 Oct; not found on SPA, the Coalition or the Defense Ministry accounts; checked 3:55 AM

Several conflict-tracking accounts posted that Saudi Arabia confirmed six of its soldiers and officers were killed in the Houthi ballistic-missile attack on Al-Maashiq palace in Aden on Thursday. No official Saudi statement was found in this check.

UNVERIFIED **Social accounts claim a missile from Yemen hit oil facilities in eastern Saudi Arabia and started a fire**

X (@RyanRozbiani, @blastradiusnet1, @dana916) · **2:50 AM** · posted 2:50-3:17 AM AST Sat 17 Oct with unverified video; no Civil Defense alert, Coalition or Aramco statement found; checked 3:55 AM

Several accounts posted that a missile from Yemen hit oil facilities in the Eastern Province and started a fire, sharing footage said to show flames. No official Saudi source has confirmed an attack or a fire; treat as an unverified claim.

**4**

KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

## Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (7728 min).

| FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY | LAST TAKEOFF | LAST LANDING | TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR | ARRIVALS DIVERTED |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 18 | — | — | 0 | 0 |
| 9 departures + 9 arrivals, 14% of 125 scheduled. | None on the board. | None on the board. | 0 landings in the last hour. | None recorded today. |

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 6:17 AM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 18 at 6:18 AM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

### FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

| MEASURE | DEPARTURES | ARRIVALS | TOTAL | BASIS |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Cancelled today, board count | 9 | 9 | 18 | FR24 boards, local day |
| Cancelled today, stats panel | 9 (16%) | 9 (13%) | 18 | FR24 stats panel |
| Delayed today | 0 (0%) | 0 (0%) | 0 | FR24 stats panel |
| On time today (share of operated) | 0 (0%) | 7 (100%) | 7 | FR24 stats panel |
| Average delay, recent flights | 0 min | 0 min | — | FR24 stats panel |
| Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far | 0 of 12 | 0 of 28 | 0 of 40 | FR24 boards |
| Diverted today | — | 0 | 0 | FR24 arrivals board |
| Already cancelled tomorrow | 139 | 120 | 259 | FR24 stats panel |
| Cancelled yesterday (for scale) | 98 | 87 | 185 | FR24 stats panel |

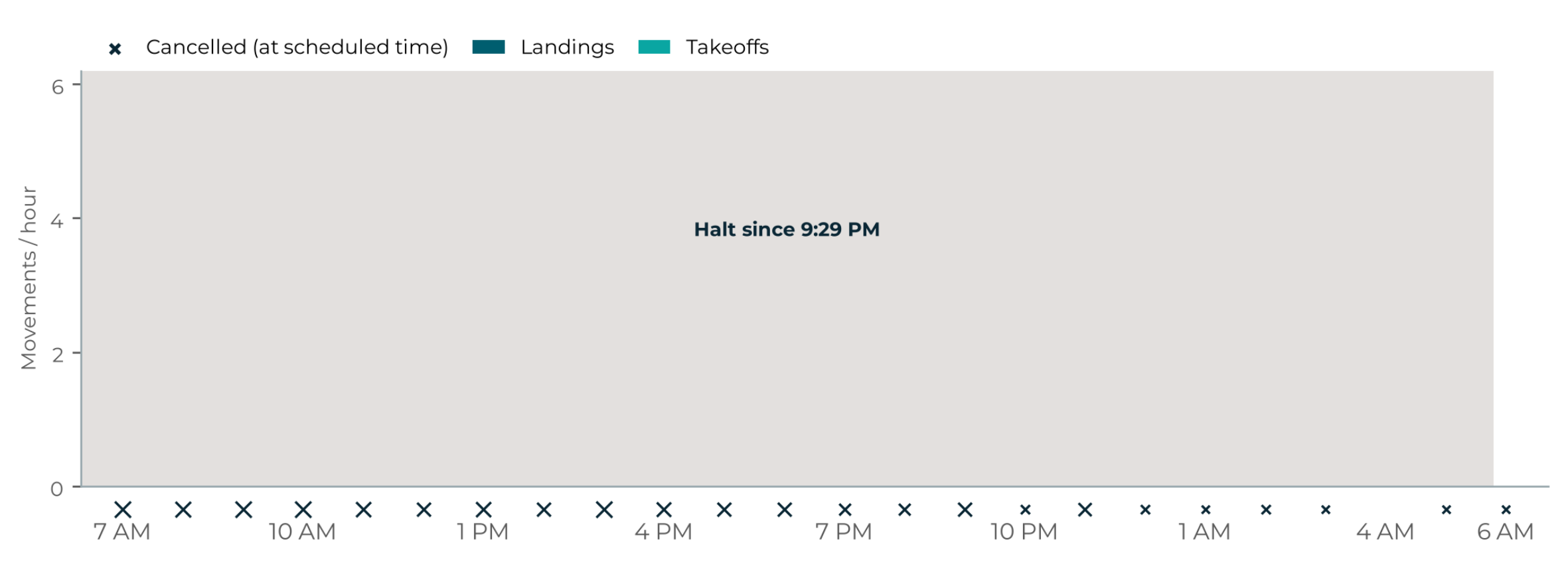
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

| | |
|---|---|
| Royal Jordanian | 6 |
| Saudia | 5 |
| airblue | 3 |
| Badr Airlines | 2 |
| flyadeal | 1 |

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

| | |
|---|---|
| Amman | 4 |
| Lahore | 2 |
| Port Sudan | 2 |
| Aqaba | 2 |
| Madinah | 2 |

### TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH



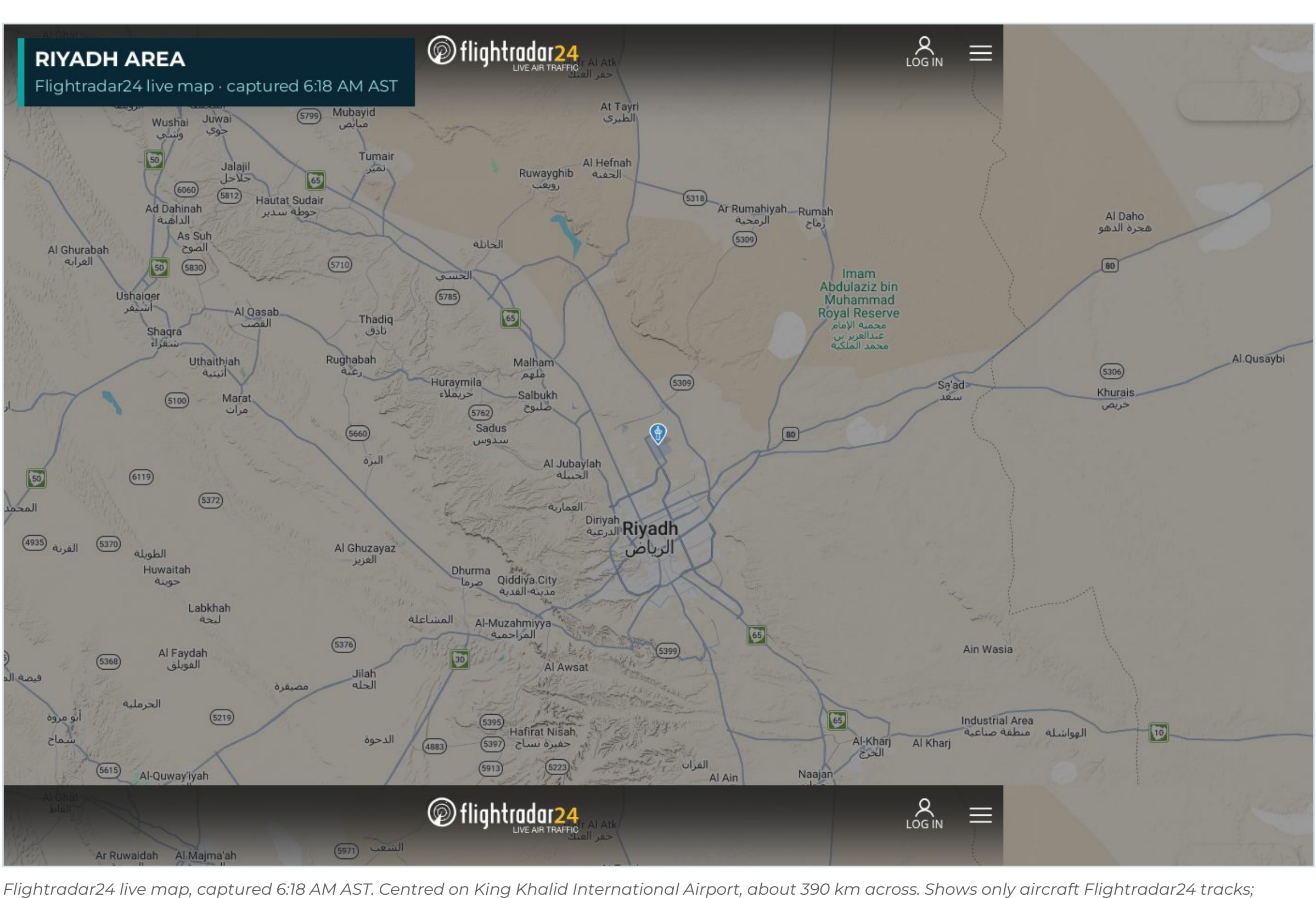
*Recorded takeoffs (0) and landings (0) at RUH per hour from 7:00 AM Friday to 6:17 AM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.*

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh's open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday covers the whole window, with no Riyadh movement in it. Dammam's halts in the window ran 8:23–9:38 AM, 4:10–5:13 PM and 5:44–7:14 PM Friday, then 11:32 PM–12:18 AM, 12:27–1:40 AM, 1:50–2:41 AM, 3:06–4:21 AM and an open halt since 5:27 AM; no takeoff has left Dammam since 1:50 AM.

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

| | |
|---|---|
| **OPEN Halt since 9:29 PM** | 7728 min and counting |

### AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA



*Flightradar24 live map, captured 6:18 AM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.*

**5**

KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

## Dammam airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 5:27 AM (50 min).

| FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY | LAST TAKEOFF | LAST LANDING | TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR | ARRIVALS DIVERTED |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 21 | 1:50 AM | 5:27 AM | 0 | 0 |
| 10 departures + 11 arrivals, 11% of 192 scheduled. | SV1131 to Jeddah, 267 min before 6:17 AM. | XY884 from Lahore, 50 min before 6:17 AM. | 1 landings in the last hour. | None recorded today. |

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 6:17 AM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 21 at 6:18 AM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

### FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

| MEASURE | DEPARTURES | ARRIVALS | TOTAL | BASIS |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Cancelled today, board count | 10 | 11 | 21 | FR24 boards, local day |
| Cancelled today, stats panel | 10 (10%) | 11 (11%) | 21 | FR24 stats panel |
| Delayed today | 4 (4%) | 5 (5%) | 9 | FR24 stats panel |
| On time today (share of operated) | 3 (43%) | 5 (50%) | 8 | FR24 stats panel |
| Average delay, recent flights | 0 min | 14 min | — | FR24 stats panel |
| Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far | 6 of 15 | 10 of 21 | 16 of 36 | FR24 boards |
| Diverted today | — | 0 | 0 | FR24 arrivals board |
| Already cancelled tomorrow | 18 | 18 | 36 | FR24 stats panel |
| Cancelled yesterday (for scale) | 31 | 37 | 68 | FR24 stats panel |

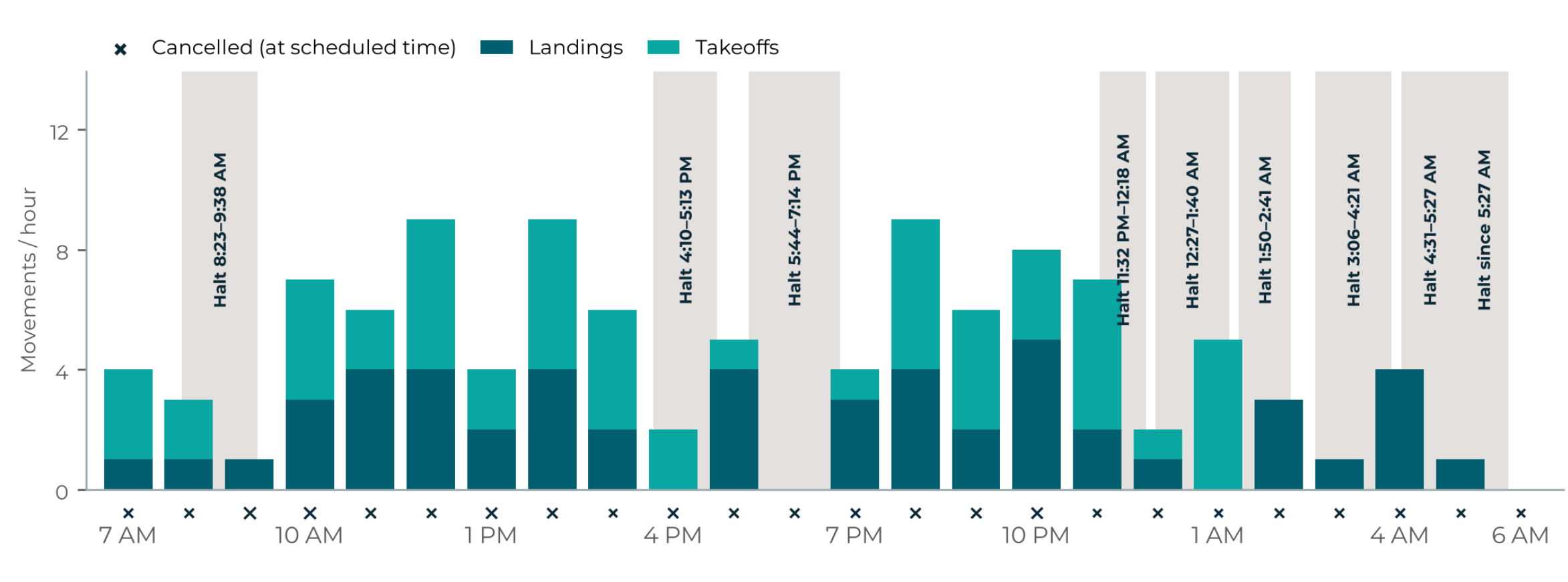
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

| | |
|---|---|
| Egyptair | 8 |
| flyadeal | 4 |
| Saudia | 4 |
| Turkish Airlines | 2 |
| Royal Jordanian | 2 |

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

| | |
|---|---|
| Jeddah | 8 |
| Cairo | 6 |
| Istanbul | 2 |
| Amman | 2 |
| Alexandria | 2 |

### TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



*Recorded takeoffs (54) and landings (52) at DMM per hour from 7:00 AM Friday to 6:17 AM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.*

Halt open since 5:27 AM. 0 takeoffs and 1 landing in the last hour; no takeoff since 1:50 AM.

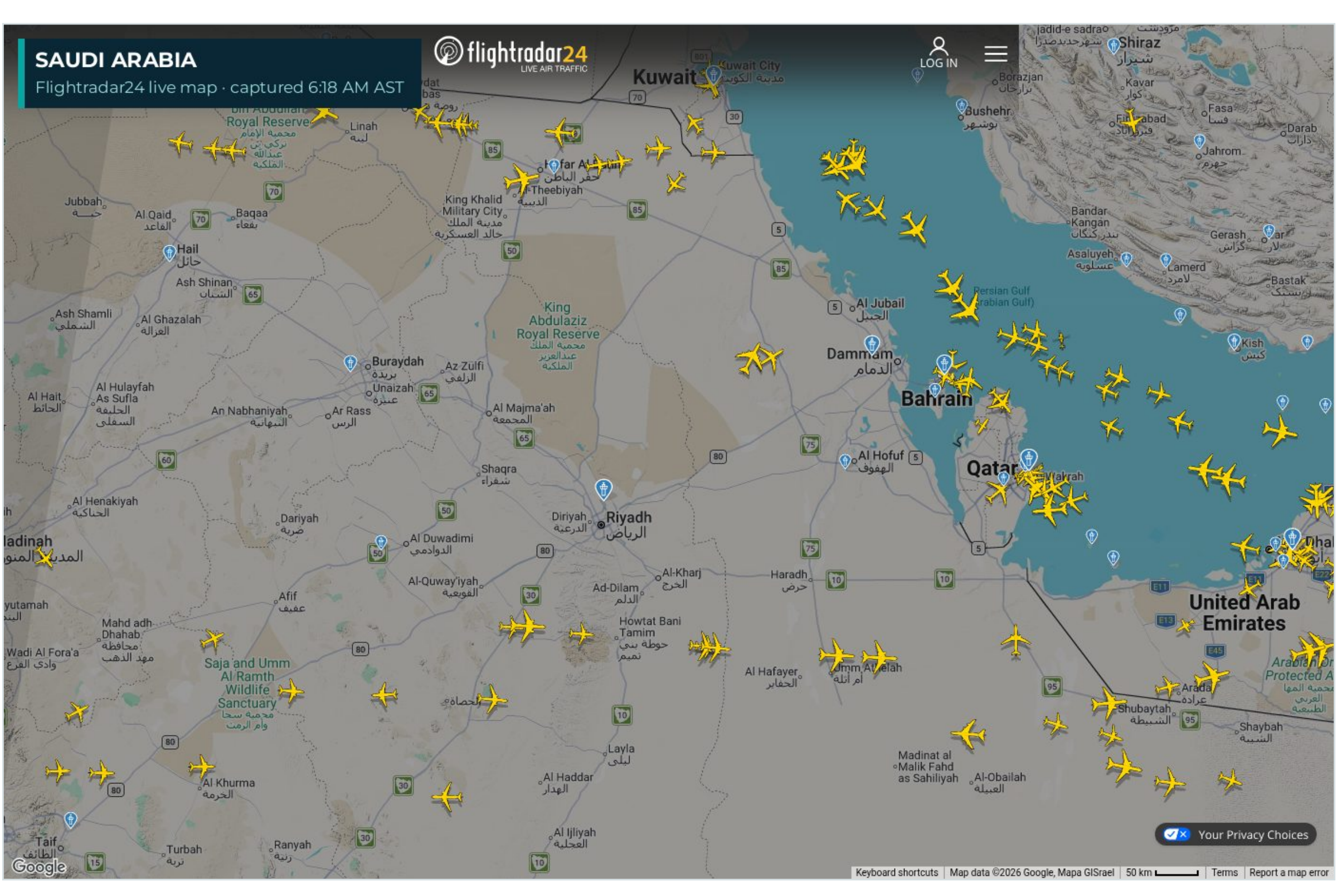
HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

| | |
|---|---|
| **OPEN Halt since 5:27 AM** | 50 min and counting |
| **Halt 4:31–5:27 AM** | 56 min |
| **Halt 3:06–4:21 AM** | 76 min |
| **Halt 1:50–2:41 AM** | 51 min |
| **Halt 12:27–1:40 AM** | 73 min |

DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

No Dammam airport-specific statement or credible report found in this edition's news check (6:20 AM).

### AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA



*Flightradar24 live map, captured 6:18 AM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.*

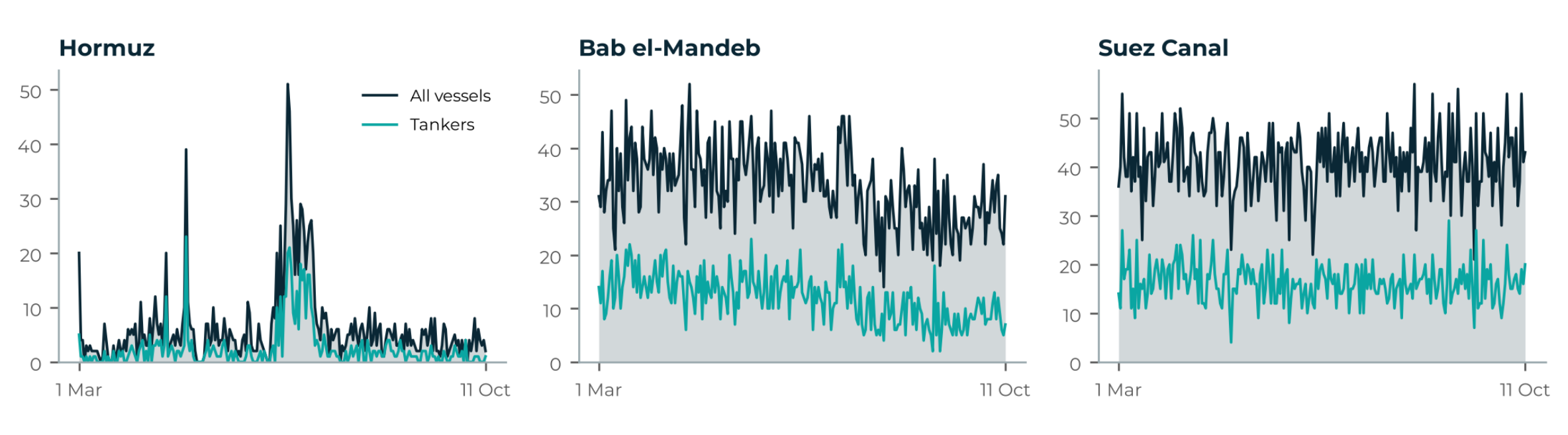
**6**

ECONOMY

## Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

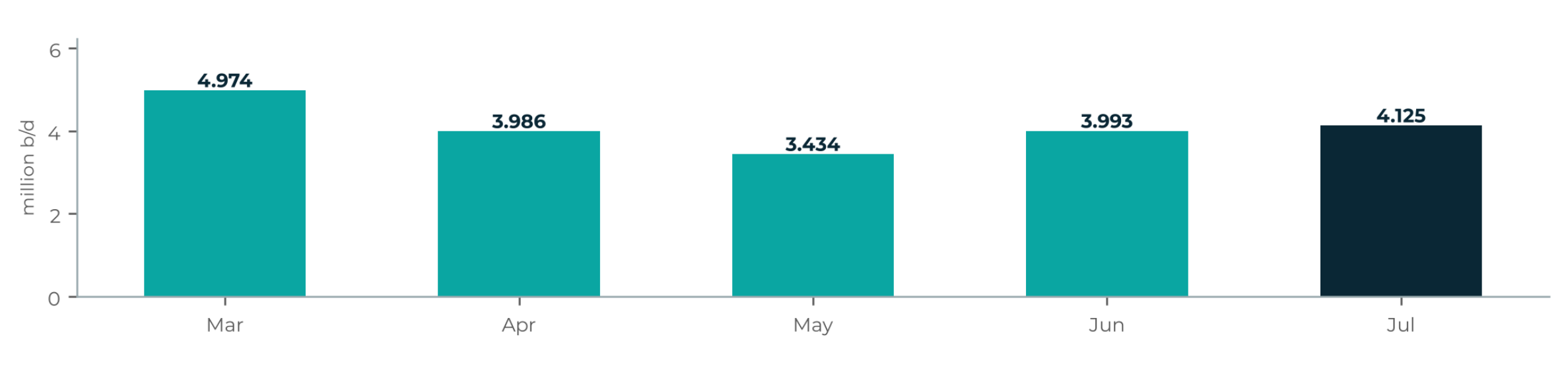
### SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

| CHOKEPOINT | LATEST DAY | ALL VESSELS | TANKERS | OTHER SHIPS | 7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Hormuz** | Sun 11 Oct | **2** | 1 | 1 | 4.1 (2.7) |
| **Bab el-Mandeb** | Sun 11 Oct | **31** | 7 | 24 | 28.3 (29.6) |
| **Suez Canal** | Sun 11 Oct | **43** | 20 | 23 | 41.7 (43.1) |



*Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. **Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.** Fetched 6:19 AM, Sat 17 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

### SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)

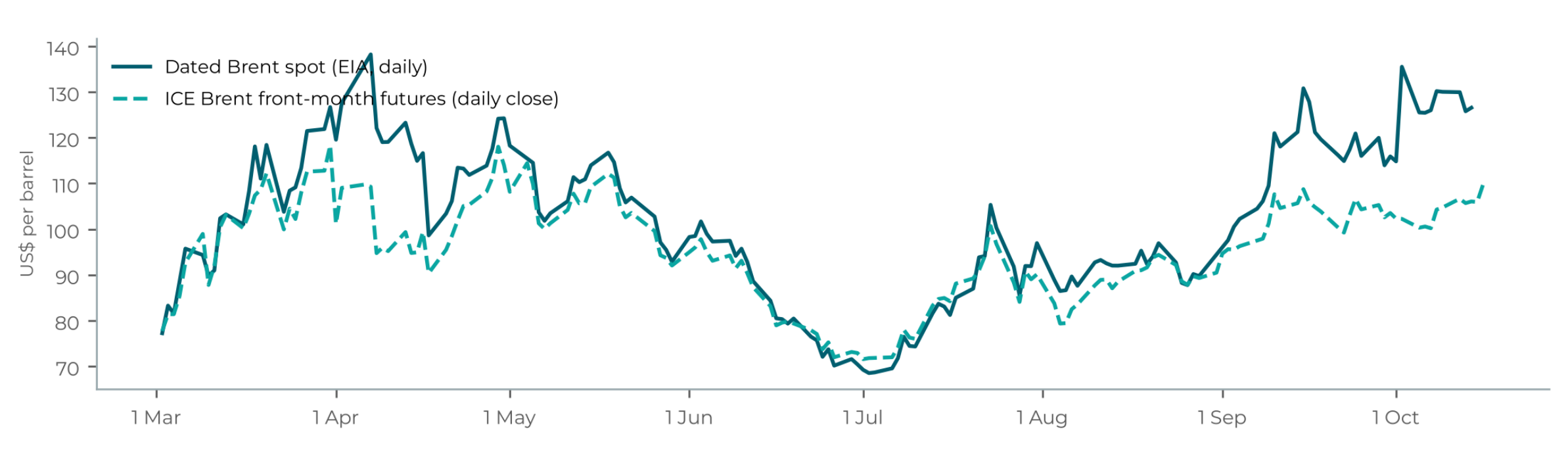


**Monthly, lagged about two months.** Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

*Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).*

### BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

| BRENT FUTURES, LATEST | DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA) | SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE | SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH |
|---|---|---|---|
| $109.69 | $126.55 | +4% | +64% |
| ICE front-month, 11:59 PM, Fri 16 Oct AST (+3.6% on day). Near real time. | Wed 14 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days. | From $121.25 on Mon 14 Sep. | From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr. |



*Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday's close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.*

**7**

METHOD AND LIMITS

## What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 6:17 AM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam's status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

| PREPARED | BOARD DATA AS OF | SOURCES | STATUS | HANDLING | NEXT UPDATE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 6:17 AM, Sat 17 Oct | 6:17 AM | Flightradar24, GACA, AIS/NOTAC, Reuters, AP, AFP, BBC, Sabq, Gulf News, Arab News, SPA | **RUH Halted · DMM Halted** | Open sources · not official | 7:00 AM |

Sources: Flightradar24, IMF PortWatch, JODI, EIA, Reuters, AP, AFP, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 7:00 AM